

“Gotta Catch ‘Em All!” Pokémon, Cultural Practice and Object Networks

The Pokémon franchise is over seventeen years old, a networked assemblage of heterogeneous elements (manga, gaming, toys, anime) that is also constitutive of new knowledges around both consumerism and commodification. This paper explores how all of the elements of this franchise, from the brand, to the various media platforms, to the Pokémon trainers, to the pocket monsters themselves (the non-human objects) as well as the designers and the consumers (the humans) function as objects in the construction of a social network. In so doing it seeks to understand not only how the franchise functions but also how the objects in this franchise (particularly the nonhuman Pokémon creatures and trainers) work in tandem to connect audiences to very specifically Japanese ideas of the “national imagination” (folklore, spiritualism, the supernatural) and environmental concerns (biodiversity, the struggle between conservation and containment) through the larger consumerist framework of acquisition and play structured as cultural practice. In this way, it is argued, that the Pokémon object network functions as a gateway into Japanese culture more broadly and a channel through which Japanese culture is itself mainstreamed internationally.

Constitutive

Which of the following best describes the term "constitutive"?

- A) Serving as a necessary part of a whole
- B) Capable of being dissolved
- C) Relating to financial matters
- D) Tending to cause harm

2. Commodification

What does "commodification" refer to?

- A) The process of turning goods and services into commodities for trade
- B) The act of conserving natural resources
- C) The method of creating unique handcrafted items
- D) The system of bartering goods without currency

3. Containment

Heads and Tails: An Analysis of Visual Signals in Cats, *Felis catus*

Communication between individuals of the same species is essential in their interactions to regulate their proximities and distances. Communication includes exchanges of more or less complex visual signals. We attempt to decipher the most significant features of a visual configuration involving the combination of tail and ear positions in interactions between cats. Although the tail is a conspicuous feature for human observers, we demonstrate that ear positions of the cats in dyadic interactions with other cats are the best predictor of the outcomes of these interactions. However, in cat–human interactions, the cat most often approached with its tail up prior to rubbing itself against the human. The results are important for a better understanding of cats' perceptions of humans, and will help to promote cat welfare.

Which of the following best defines "proximity"?

- A) The degree of similarity between two objects
- B) The state of being near in space or time
- C) The tendency to form relationships with distant individuals
- D) The measure of an object's intrinsic value

Which scenario best illustrates the meaning of "conspicuous"?

- A) A chameleon blending into its environment
- B) A brightly colored bird displaying its plumage
- C) A nocturnal animal hiding during the day
- D) A fish swimming deep underwater

In social network analysis, what does the term "dyadic" describe?

- A) Interactions involving multiple groups
- B) A relationship between two individuals
- C) A solitary individual's behavior
- D) The influence of environmental factors on a population

The Ethics of AI in Games

Video games are one of the richest and most popular forms of human-computer interaction and, hence, their role is critical for our understanding of human behaviour and affect at a large scale. As artificial intelligence (AI) tools are gradually adopted by the game industry a series of ethical concerns arise. Such concerns, however, have so far not been extensively discussed in a video game context. Motivated by the lack of a comprehensive review of the ethics of AI as applied to games, we survey the current state of the art in this area and discuss ethical considerations of these systems from the holistic perspective of the affective loop. Through the components of this loop, we study the ethical challenges that AI faces in video game development. Elicitation highlights the ethical boundaries of artificially induced emotions; sensing showcases the trade-off between privacy and safe gaming spaces; and detection, as utilised during in-game adaptation, poses challenges to transparency and ownership. This paper calls for an open dialogue and action for the games of today and the virtual spaces of the future. By setting an appropriate framework we aim to protect users and to guide developers towards safer and better experiences for their customers.

1. Affect

In psychology, which statement best describes "affect"?

- A) A long-term emotional state not tied to a specific event
- B) A temporary feeling or emotion in response to a stimulus
- C) A cognitive process involving logical reasoning
- D) A behavioral trait determined by genetic factors

2. Holistic

Which approach exemplifies a "holistic" perspective in healthcare?

- A) Treating only the symptoms of a disease
- B) Focusing solely on the psychological aspects of a patient
- C) Considering the physical, mental, and social factors affecting a patient's health
- D) Utilizing exclusively pharmaceutical interventions

3. Elicitation

In the context of data collection, what does "elicitation" refer to?

- A) The process of suppressing irrelevant information
- B) The act of drawing out information or responses from individuals
- C) The technique of encoding data for analysis

D) The method of storing data in a secure database

Note: The correct answers are: 1) B, 2) C, 3) B.

German-Japanese Relations from Meiji to Heisei

Scholars have debated for decades whether there has ever been any meaningful partnership between Germany and Japan. A minority of specialists rejects the idea of a significant cooperation between the two nations and points especially to various diplomatic breaches between both countries. The German participation in the Triple Intervention in 1895, the Japanese take-over of the German leasehold in the Chinese Shandong province (Qingdao) in 1914, and the Hitler-Stalin Pact in 1939, which rendered the Anti-Comintern Pact of 1936 obsolete, are examples of such incidents. Another reason why some contest the notion of partnership is the alleged joint world conspiracy of Berlin and Tokyo, a mistaken charge that turned out to be little more than the result of German-Japanese-Italian indoctrination and the Allied response with their own anti-Axis propaganda. That is, during the early 1940s, both sides portrayed the Berlin-Rome-Tokyo wartime alliance as a firmly antidemocratic or “fascist” bloc. After clearing the smokescreen of wartime verbiage, however, scholars have questioned the actual degree of solidarity and depth of the Axis agreements.¹ In fact, the international situation after World War I with its threefold confrontation between democracies, militarist/fascist countries, and communism played an important role in bringing about this alliance. The German-Japanese cooperation then led to the heterogeneous anti-Hitler coalition, which collapsed after the Potsdam Conference, quickly leading to the Cold War, with divided Germany as one of its foremost battlegrounds.

1. Leasehold

What defines a leasehold?

- A) Temporary property rights under a contract
- B) Permanent ownership of land
- C) Government-controlled real estate
- D) A historical land grant system

2. Verbiage

How does excessive verbiage affect a document?

- A) Increases clarity
- B) Makes interpretation harder
- C) Strengthens arguments
- D) Ensures universal agreement

3. Solidarity

Which best shows solidarity?

- A) Workers uniting for rights
- B) A company raising executive wages
- C) A nation prioritizing self-interest
- D) A government enforcing individualism

